

IIRSM Course Approval

Risk Management & Leadership Competency Framework — Course Alignment

Chainsaw Cross-Cutting — eLearning Course

Document Date	30 July 2026
Version	1.0
Course Type	eLearning (no trainer)
Applicant Type	New to IIRSM Course Approval
Approval Sought	Initial 18-month approval

1. PURPOSE OF THIS DOCUMENT

This document maps the content of the Chainsaw Cross-Cutting eLearning course against the IIRSM Risk Management and Leadership Competency Framework. It is prepared to support the IIRSM Course Approval application and demonstrates how each module of the course aligns to the competency areas and levels defined within the Framework.

The course is designed to be assessed at the Operational level of the Framework, with selected modules also addressing Managerial-level competences in risk assessment, legal compliance, and emergency planning.

2. COURSE SCOPE AND POSITIONING

This eLearning course provides the theoretical knowledge and understanding required to support candidates preparing for the NPTC Unit CS30/CS31 practical chainsaw certification. It does not constitute legal authorisation to operate a chainsaw and does not replace the mandatory practical assessment conducted by a LANTRA or NPTC-approved assessor.

The course covers four topic areas across 35 modules: Course Requirements, Standards & Regulations, Chainsaw Maintenance, and Cross-Cutting Techniques. Each module comprises video content, structured reading, and a knowledge-check quiz. Learner progress, quiz scores, and feedback are recorded throughout and are available for review by IIRSM assessors via the platform.

3. COURSE MODULES OVERVIEW

COURSE REQUIREMENTS	Equipment List (M8)
STANDARDS & REGULATIONS	PPE & First Aid (M9) · 5 Steps To Risk Assessment (M10) · Hazards & Risks (M11) · Emergency Planning Information (M12) · Law & Regulations (M13) · Chainsaw Safety Features (M14)
CHAINSAW MAINTENANCE	Battery Chainsaws (M40) · Air Filter (M15) · Spark Plug (M16) · Cooling System (M17) · Exhaust (M18) · Fuel & Oil Filters (M19) · Oiling System (M41) · Recoil Starter (M20) · Clutch Assembly (M21) · Sprocket (M22) · Chain Brake (M23) · Guidebar (M24) · Chain Basics (M25) · Chain Tension (M26) · Identifying Chain (M27) · Replacing Chain (M28) · Chain Sharpening (M29)
CROSS-CUTTING TECHNIQUES	Kickback (M42) · Work Positioning (M31) · Pre-Start Checks (M32) · Starting The Chainsaw (M33) · Pre-Use Checks (M34) · Cutting Basics (M35) · Tension & Compression (M36) · Releasing A Trapped Chainsaw (M37) · Bore Cutting (M38) · Oversized & Tensioned Timber (M39) · Stacking (M30) · Additional Cuts (M43)

4. COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK MAPPING

The table below maps each IIRSM Risk Management and Leadership Competency Area to the specific modules in this course. Competency levels are assigned as: Operational (O) — knowledge and understanding with some application; Managerial (M) — clear application and knowledge; Strategic (S) — reasoned advice and depth of complexity.

IIRSM Competency Area	Modules Covered	Level
1. Hazard Identification <i>Identifying sources of harm in the work environment</i>	Hazards & Risks (M11) · Chainsaw Safety Features (M14) · Kickback (M42) · Tension & Compression (M36) · Bore Cutting (M38) · Oversized & Tensioned Timber (M39)	Operational
2. Risk Assessment <i>Evaluating likelihood, severity and overall risk rating</i>	5 Steps To Risk Assessment (M10) · Hazards & Risks (M11) · PPE & First Aid (M9) · Work Positioning (M31)	Operational / Managerial
3. Risk Control <i>Implementing the hierarchy of control and preventative measures</i>	PPE & First Aid (M9) · Chain Brake (M23) · Work Positioning (M31) · Pre-Start Checks (M32) · Pre-Use Checks (M34) · Kickback (M42) · Releasing A Trapped Chainsaw (M37) · Stacking (M30)	Operational
4. Legal & Regulatory Compliance <i>Understanding and applying relevant legislation and standards</i>	Law & Regulations (M13) · PPE & First Aid (M9) · Chainsaw Safety Features (M14) · Chain Brake (M23)	Operational / Managerial
5. Emergency Planning & Response <i>Preparing for and responding to emergencies</i>	Emergency Planning Information (M12) · PPE & First Aid (M9)	Operational
6. Equipment Safety & Maintenance <i>Safe use, inspection and maintenance of work equipment (PUWER)</i>	Equipment List (M8) · Air Filter (M15) · Spark Plug (M16) · Cooling System (M17) · Exhaust (M18) · Fuel & Oil Filters (M19) · Oiling System (M41) · Recoil Starter (M20) · Clutch Assembly (M21) · Sprocket (M22) · Chain Brake (M23) · Guidebar (M24) · Battery Chainsaws (M40) · Pre-Start Checks (M32) · Pre-Use Checks (M34)	Operational
7. Safe Working Practices <i>Applying safe methods of work and task procedures</i>	Starting The Chainsaw (M33) · Cutting Basics (M35) · Bore Cutting (M38) · Oversized & Tensioned Timber (M39) · Additional Cuts (M43) · Work Positioning (M31) · Releasing A Trapped Chainsaw (M37) · Stacking (M30)	Operational
8. Chain & Cutting Tool Management <i>Competence in chain selection, tensioning and maintenance</i>	Chain Basics (M25) · Chain Tension (M26) · Identifying Chain (M27) · Replacing Chain (M28) · Chain Sharpening (M29) · Guidebar (M24)	Operational
9. Communication of Risk <i>Communicating risk information clearly to relevant parties</i>	Emergency Planning Information (M12) · 5 Steps To Risk Assessment (M10) · Hazards & Risks (M11)	Operational
10. Health & Wellbeing <i>Managing occupational health risks including manual handling (MHOR)</i>	PPE & First Aid (M9) · Stacking (M30) · Work Positioning (M31) · Chainsaw Safety Features (M14)	Operational

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE EVIDENCE

In accordance with IIRSM requirements, the following quality assurance mechanisms are in place:

Delegate Feedback	Module-level star ratings and comments collected at end of each module. App-level feedback collected on course completion. All records retained in a tamper-evident database with timestamped entries. Minimum 12-month retention guaranteed.
Feedback into Development	Feedback data is reviewed by the course developer at quarterly intervals. A dedicated admin dashboard provides exportable feedback reports. Course content is updated following any pattern of negative feedback or regulatory change.
Assessment Records	All quiz attempts, scores, pass/fail outcomes, and timestamps are stored per learner. Mock exam and final exam results are similarly retained. Records are exportable via the Google Sheets backup system for external audit.
Learner Completion Data	Progress tracking records video watched status, quiz pass status, and timestamps for each of the 35 modules per learner. A completion certificate is issued only on full course and exam completion.

Platform Access for Assessors

IIRSM assessors can be granted a full-access learner account to experience the course as a delegate, plus a read-only admin account to review all learner data, feedback, and assessment records.

6. DECLARATION

I confirm that the information provided in this document and the accompanying IIRSM Course Approval application is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge. The course content aligns to the IIRSM Risk Management and Leadership Competency Framework at the Operational level as mapped above. I undertake to notify IIRSM of any material changes to course content, trainers, or organisational policies during the period of approval.

Signature _____

Date: 30 July 2026 _____